BASH + VIM | Host and evidence workflow

Bash on Linux • replace <PLACEHOLDERS> • read left to right: orient -> inspect -> filter -> automate -> edit

COMMAND / PATTERN	WHAT / WHEN / CHECK
01 ORIENT / LOCATE	
`pwd; id; hostname` `cat /etc/os-release`	Location, identity/groups and OS.

`ls -lah`
`stat -- <FILE>`
`file -- <FILE>`
	Hidden files, metadata, type. Inspect before editing.

`find . -type f -name '*.log'` `rg --files -g '*.conf'`	Find names. Quote globs; rg skips ignored/hidden files.
`ip -br addr; ip route` `ss -tuln`	Addresses, route and listeners; -p adds process data.
02 READ / SEARCH / PRESERVE	

`less <FILE>`
`head -n 20 <FILE>`
`tail -n 50 <FILE>`
	Page / first / last lines. less: /pattern, n, q.

`rg -n -i 'denied|failed' <LOG>` `grep -En 'denied|failed' <LOG>`	Regex + line numbers; grep fallback without rg.
`rg -n -F 'user$' <FILE>`	Literal search: -F and single quotes keep $ literal.
`sha256sum <FILE>` `cp -p -- <FILE> <COPY>`	Hash source; use a copy. Integrity is not safety.
`<COMMAND> >out.txt 2>err.txt` `<COMMAND> 2>&1 | tee run.txt`	Separate or merge stderr; > overwrites, >> appends.
03 FILTER WITH A CHECK	

`grep -E 'PATTERN' raw.txt >kept.txt`
`grep -Ev 'PATTERN' raw.txt >rejected.txt`
`wc -l raw.txt kept.txt rejected.txt`
	Inspect both sets; kept + rejected should equal raw.

`awk '{print $1}' kept.txt`
`sort users.txt | uniq -c`
`sort -u hosts.txt`
	Fields; counts; unique values. Preserve raw order.

`jq -r '.[] | [.host,.port] | @tsv' data.json`	JSON parser; jq optional. Avoid splitting CSV on commas.

COMMAND / PATTERN	WHAT / WHEN / CHECK
04 QUOTING / SMALL AUTOMATION	
`target="192.0.2.10"` `printf '%s\n' "$target"`	Double quotes expand; single quotes preserve literals.

`[[ -r "$file" ]] && cat -- "$file"`
`if (( count > 50 )); then`
`  printf '%s\n' "Review volume"`
`fi`
	Readable file; Bash numeric test. Avoid [$x > 50].

`while IFS= read -r line; do`
`  printf '%s\n' "$line"`
`done < hosts.txt`
	Preserve whitespace/backslashes when reading lines.

`for file in ./*.log; do`
`  [[ -f "$file" ]] || continue`
`  wc -l -- "$file"`
`done`
	Quote paths; guard against an unmatched glob.

`bash -n script.sh` `set -o pipefail`	Syntax check; pipeline failure propagation.
05 LOCAL LEADS / VERIFY THE BOUNDARY	

`sudo -l`
`find / -type f -perm -4000 2>find.err`
`ps aux; systemctl --type=service`
	Inspect sudo, SUID and services; leads are not proof.

`ls -l <PATH>` `namei -l <PATH>`	Check file AND parent-directory access.
06 VIM — USE THIS INSTEAD OF NANO	
`vim <FILE>` `i / a / o  Esc`	Open; insert / append / new line. Esc: Normal mode.

`h j k l  w / b`
`0 / $  gg / G`
`:42`
	Move; word; line ends; file ends; go to line 42.

`/pattern  n / N`
`:set number`
`:set paste  :set nopaste`
	Search; line numbers; fallback paste mode on/off.

`yy / p  dd` `ciw  u / Ctrl+r`	Yank/paste; delete line; change word; undo/redo.
`:%s/old/new/gc` `:w  :wq  :q!`	Confirm replacement; save / save+quit / discard.

Pathway: Linux/offensive evidence handling + scripting foundations. Keep source data, verify filters, never assume a tool-highlighted lead is proof.